May his memory be a blessing.

November 3, 1995, the day before the murder, was like any other Friday. On Fridays, Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin, who also served as defense minister, used to work in his office in the IDF's headquarters in Tel Aviv. These Fridays were crammed with discussions about security, ranging from presentations for approval for operations and sorties to consultations on weighty security issues with the heads of the defense establishment, either separately or together in various groups, depending on the case.

Friday, November 3, was just like that. A consultation took place that morning between the defense minister; IDF chief of staff Amnon Lipkin-Shahak; head of Military Intelligence Moshe ("Bogey") Ya'alon; a representative of the Shin Bet; and the director of the Mossad (myself). We discussed two issues—the ongoing challenge of terrorism and the strategic issue of the buildup of nonconventional weapons in the Middle East in general and in Iran in particular. During the first part of the discussion, reference was made to the extreme Right's protest activity. Rabin, the defense minister, dismissed it casually. None of the people around the table could have imagined that thirty hours later the prime minister would be murdered.

On Saturday night, November 4, I was sitting at home with my wife, Yael, watching the rally on TV that was being held in the square outside of Tel Aviv's city hall. At about 10 p.m. the phone rang. It was Danny Yatom, Yitzhak's military secretary. "Yitzhak has been shot by an assassin," Danny said. "He's on his way to Ichilov Hospital."

"I'll be right there!" I said, and hung up the phone. I do not remember the trip from my home in Ramat Hasharon to Ichilov Hospital in Tel Aviv, but in my memory time seemed to have stopped. I went down to the hospital's operating room and found a corner where I stood leaning against the wall, contemplating. The area around the operating rooms was filling up with cabinet ministers, foreign ambassadors, senior officers, and friends. Leah Rabin sat inside one of the rooms that had been cleared for her, together with other family members. The whole crowd awaited news of Yitzhak's condition.

It seemed that an eternity had passed by the time the director of the hospital, Prof. Gabi Barabash, came out of the operating room. His statement was laconic: "Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin has died."